LAB 9 & 10 – Technical Writing Assignment

Research Article Preparation and Journal Publication

Practical / Project-Based Assignment

Title: Preparation, Publication Ethics, Journal Identification, and Submission of a Research Article

Course: Technical Writing , Lab No.: 09 & 10

1. Aim

To develop students' practical skills in preparing a quality research article, maintaining academic integrity, identifying a suitable zero-APC Open Access journal, and completing the journal submission process.

2. Learning Outcomes

After completing this assignment, students will be able to:

1. Identify a relevant research problem in Computer Science and Engineering.
2. Conduct a literature review using authentic research papers.
3. Prepare a well-structured research article following academic writing conventions.
4. Maintain originality and adhere to research publication ethics.
5. Identify a suitable Diamond Open Access journal with zero publication charges.
6. Understand journal submission guidelines and complete the submission process.

3. Assignment Description

Each student (or team, if permitted by the faculty member) must prepare an original research article on a relevant topic in Computer Science and related domains.

Suggested research areas:

- Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning
- Data Science and Big Data Analytics
- Natural Language Processing
- Generative AI and Large Language Models
- Internet of Things (IoT)

- Cloud Computing and Edge Computing
- Cybersecurity and Blockchain
- Software Engineering
- Computer Networks
- Image Processing and Computer Vision
- Recommender Systems
- Web Mining and Information Retrieval

4. Mandatory Requirements

Each student must satisfy the following requirements:

Component	**Requirement**
Research article	Original, well-structured manuscript
Similarity index	Below 10%
AI-generated content indicator	Target: 0% AI-generated content detected
References	Minimum 15–20 authentic scholarly references
Publication model	Open Access
APC	Zero publication charges
Preferred journal	Diamond Open Access
Submission	Actual submission to a suitable journal

Important academic integrity conditions:

- Students must write and understand their own research work.
- Copying, fabricated references, fabricated experimental results, and unauthorized reuse of published content are strictly prohibited.
- AI tools may be used only in accordance with the faculty's instructions and the target journal's AI policy. Any required disclosure must be included.
- The AI detection score is a screening indicator, not definitive proof of authorship. Students must not attempt to manipulate detection tools. The final assessment will also consider the student's understanding and ability to defend the article.

COPE and DOAJ provide useful guidance on AI disclosure and publication ethics.

COPE: Committee on Publication Ethics+2

5. Research Article Structure

Students must prepare their manuscript using the following structure:

1. Title of the Research Article
2. Abstract (150–250 words)

3. Keywords (4–6)
4. Introduction
5. Literature Review / Related Work
6. Research Gap and Problem Statement
7. Research Objectives
8. Proposed Methodology / Research Framework
9. Results and Discussion (where applicable)
10. Conclusion and Future Scope
11. References (IEEE or journal-prescribed style)

Note: Students undertaking review-based research should use an appropriate review methodology instead of presenting fabricated experimental results.

6. Journal Identification and Verification

After completing the research article, each student must identify at least three potential journals and compare them.

The selected journal must satisfy the following conditions:

- Publishes articles in the student's research domain.
- Provides immediate Open Access to published articles.
- Does not charge APC, submission fees, page charges, or other mandatory publication fees.
- Has a transparent peer-review process.
- Provides authentic editorial board and publisher information.
- Accepts the article type being submitted.

Students should give preference to Diamond Open Access journals. According to UNESCO, Diamond OA means neither authors nor readers pay publication or access fees.

Useful journal discovery resources:

- Directory of Open Access Journals (DOAJ)
- SCImago Journal Rankings
- Committee on Publication Ethics (COPE)

Students must verify the journal's current fee policy directly on its official website. A journal being Open Access does not automatically mean it is free for authors.

7. Journal Comparison Table

Students must prepare the following comparison before finalising their target journal.

Criteria	Journal 1	Journal 2	Journal 3
Journal name			
Publisher			
Official website			
Research scope			
Open Access			
APC			
Submission fee			
Peer-review policy			
Indexing databases			
Publication frequency			
Selected / Not selected			

8. Journal Submission Process

After obtaining faculty approval, students must:

1. Visit the official website of the selected journal.
2. Register as an author.
3. Read the Instructions for Authors.
4. Format the manuscript according to the journal template.
5. Prepare the cover letter.
6. Prepare author details and declarations.
7. Upload the manuscript and supporting documents.
8. Complete the online submission process.
9. Save the manuscript submission confirmation and manuscript ID.

Important: Students must not submit the same manuscript simultaneously to multiple journals. Actual submission must be made only after faculty approval and confirmation of authorship, journal suitability, and publication ethics. Acceptance or publication is not guaranteed.

9. Deliverables / Submission Requirements

Each student must submit the following documents in a single assignment folder:

Sl. No.	Deliverable
1	Final research article in MS Word format
2	Research article in PDF format
3	Similarity report showing below 10%
4	AI detection report showing the requested target of 0%, if a reliable institutional tool is available
5	Comparison of three potential journals
6	Evidence of zero APC and Open Access policy
7	Cover letter addressed to the Editor-in-Chief
8	Screenshot/PDF of completed journal submission
9	Journal submission ID and confirmation email

10. Evaluation Criteria

Total: 100 Marks

Assessment component	Marks
Research topic selection and problem identification	10
Literature review and research gap	15
Research article structure and technical writing	20
Originality and publication ethics	15
Similarity and AI screening compliance	10
Identification and evaluation of zero-APC journals	10
Manuscript formatting and cover letter	10
Actual journal submission and viva	10
Total	100

Dear Students,

Greetings!

As part of Lab 09 & 10 (Technical Writing), you are required to undertake a complete research publication activity.

You must prepare an original research article in a relevant area of Computer Science and Engineering, ensuring a similarity index of **less than 10%** and targeting **0% AI-generated content detection**.

After completing the manuscript, you must identify a suitable **Open Access, Zero-APC (preferably Diamond Open Access) journal**, verify its publication policies, and submit your research article to the selected journal after obtaining faculty approval.

This assignment is intended to provide you with practical exposure to academic research, scholarly writing, publication ethics, journal selection, manuscript preparation, and the actual journal submission process.

Remember: Your objective is not merely to prepare a research paper, but to experience the complete research-to-publication process.

All submissions must be supported by the required reports, journal comparison, and submission confirmation evidence.

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